

Research Laboratory Operations Guide

Loblolly Ridge Therapeutics | Facilities, Lab Operations & EHS | 2026-03-16

How the Woodlands research laboratory runs day to day: its areas, how to book instruments, how maintenance and calibration are handled, where samples live, the safety basics and who to call. Read it in your first week and keep it handy. Rev. C, March 2026.

The laboratory at a glance

The laboratory occupies 17,500 square feet in the same building as our offices in The Woodlands. It has five areas: bioanalytical and analytical, cell biology, assay development, chemistry support and shared equipment. About 20 instruments are booked through the instrument calendar; the rest are open use or assigned to a team.

Research at the Woodlands laboratory is non-GxP. We still keep research records attributable, contemporaneous and reviewed, because the data feed decisions and may later support regulatory documents. GLP work is done only at qualified external testing facilities.

Booking instruments

Book bookable instruments in the instrument calendar in 30-minute blocks, up to four weeks ahead.

Cancel at least 24 hours ahead so someone else can use the slot.

The two LC-MS/MS triple-quadrupole systems also run an unattended overnight queue, giving about 100 available hours a week each. Load overnight batches through the DMPK queue, not the calendar.

If an instrument is faulty, mark the booking and tell Lab Operations the same day; do not attempt repairs yourself.

Maintenance and calibration

Service vendors carry out preventive maintenance every 6 to 12 months depending on instrument type. Lab Operations schedules the visits and books the instrument out in the calendar. Maintenance and calibration records are kept in the Lab Operations spreadsheet and in the vendors' portals. Check the calibration label before using a balance or pipette; if it is past due, use another and tell Lab Operations.

Samples, freezers and inventory

Register every sample in the assay and sample registry before it goes into storage, and label it with the registry ID. Freezer positions are recorded on the freezer map on the Lab Operations share. Do not store food or personal items in any laboratory freezer or refrigerator. Chemicals are received and logged by Lab Operations into the chemical inventory before use.

Safety basics

Complete laboratory safety training before starting work, and refresher training every year.

Wear a lab coat, safety glasses and gloves in all laboratory areas.

Biohazard waste goes in the red bins; Lab Operations arranges pickup.

Freezer alarms page the on-call Lab Operations staff member. If you hear an alarm out of hours and no one has responded, call the on-call number posted at each freezer bank.

Report every spill, injury or near miss to Lab Operations the same day.

Contacts

Lab Operations & EHS (bookings, maintenance, freezers, waste, training): Beth Kowalczyk, Manager, Lab Operations & EHS.

LC-MS/MS queue and bioanalytical methods: DMPK & Bioanalytical, Dr. Mateo Arriaga.

ELN, assay registry and data hub access: Research Informatics, Samuel Oyelaran.

Instrument computers and network: IT, Tyler Brandon.